

Now she thanks God every day that she can do good missionary work. An expert stenographer & typist she keep her diary, hardly ever missing.

July 17 - seventeenth anniversary of an operation this poor son of Adam underwent in St. Francis' Hospital, N.Y.C. It was Sunday, planned for 10 a.m. (just a little rupture) but "an urgent case of appendicitis" came in just as the orderly was to call me and so, I was put back. ... I had been in agony for at least forty hours, though no one else seemed to know it, and while I tried to thank God for it all, my principal prayer - at least a thousand times repeated - was: "God help us!"

Well the operation took place just as the noon Angelus was ringing. I had promised the sister the night before to say holy Mass at 6 o'clock - "Please God" I said. Thank God I did say holy Mass and gave Holy Communion to the sisters and patients. It was certainly one of the most beautiful and happy experiences I have ever remembered, Thanks be to God! I certainly would not 've missed it for all it cost me. Something that almost was a scandal to Doctor and sisters was the fact that I missed only one holy Mass. This was due to happy mistake on my part and an accidental disobedience to orders. Ha Ha! We ought rather to say it was due to a beautiful disposition of the merciful providence of our divine Sweetheart.

But Dear Sister, What a diversion! Whither am I going? Please pray that I learn consistency and conciseness and something more of prudence, etc, etc.

Of course you know we are expected in Superior for Fr. Edward's jubilee. He was here about three weeks ago and told us of some general plans; but since that I've had no word from him. I know his affairs keep him hustling I am not anxious about particulars. I have plenty to keep me busy myself for at least eighteen hours a day. I console myself occasionally with the thought that sooner or later the day will come when they will say of poor Fr. S. "...He's gone." Please God the struggle for existence will then be over. I just hope that by that time I'll be able to exclaim with St. Paul when shortly before he died - a martyr - : "I (desire) long to be dissolved and to be with Christ." O well it will not be long. "What are fifty years of pain to the endless joys awaiting us above?"